

Case Studies: What to Say, and the Videos

Build Your AI-Powered 90-Day Marketing Campaign for the Holidays Branches B1 · The Creative Strategist

Three case studies, on slides 13, 24 and 31. Each slide has a narrow empty frame on the right for a video still or a screenshot, which you can drop in yourself.

On the numbers. Everything below is sourced and linked. Where a widely repeated figure is shaky, I have said so rather than putting it on a slide. If you want to quote something not listed here, check it first, because a wrong number in front of a room is worse than no number.

Slide 13 · REI Closed on Black Friday

Where it sits: Topic 1, right after One Message, Many Skins. It is the proof that one idea, repeated, beats a new idea every time.

The story, in your words:

In 2015 REI did the unthinkable. They closed every single store on Black Friday, the biggest shopping day of the year, and paid all of their employees to go outside instead. They did not discount anything. They did not open online. They just said: go outside, we will be here Saturday.

And then, this is the important part, they did it again the next year. And the next. Same message, every November, for years. That is not a stunt, that is a campaign.

The numbers on the slide:

Figure	What it is	Source
2.7 billion	Media impressions in the first 24 hours	Retail TouchPoints
Up 23%	Digital sales in 2015	Same
150+	Other retailers who closed too that first year	Sprout Social

Also reported for 2015, if you want more: revenue up 9.3%, comparable store sales up 7%, and a roughly 7,000% jump in social mentions in year one.

The line that makes it land for this room:

You are not REI and you are not closing your shop. That is not the lesson. The lesson is that they found one idea they were willing to say every single year, and it got louder each time. What is yours?

Video: [REI, #OptOutside Case Study](#) · 2:21

Short, made as a case study, and covers the whole thing. This is the one I would play.

Backup if you want the emotional version rather than the results version: [#OptOutside, Will You Go Out With Me?](#)

Slide 24 · A Business Your Size

Where it sits: Topic 3, after Trend Days and before Which Dates Are Actually Yours. This is the one that makes the room lean in, because it is finally somebody their size.

Why it is here and not a big brand: REI and Patagonia make the principle land fast because everybody has heard of them. This one makes it believable. Use it deliberately as the counterweight: "that was a company with a marketing department, here is a bakery."

The business: Miette Patisserie and Confiserie, San Francisco. Owner Meg Ray. Four shops.

The story, in your words:

Meg Ray runs four small bakeries in San Francisco. Not a chain, not a marketing department, just her and four shops.

Her problem was not that people did not want her cakes. It was that buying one online was harder than walking in. Different prices in different places, no way to see what was actually in stock, no easy pickup.

So she did not run a campaign at all. She just made buying online as easy as buying at the counter. Same prices, real stock, order now and pick it up today.

The numbers on the slide:

Figure	What it is	Source
+105%	Cake sales	Square case study
+53%	Holiday candy sales	Same
4	Shops, one owner	Same

Two honest caveats, and you should say the first one out loud:

1. **Square published this**, and Square sells the tools she used. That does not make the numbers false, but it does mean it is a vendor case study, not independent reporting. Saying so costs you nothing and buys you credibility for the rest of the day.
2. The case study does not state the exact time period the increases cover. I have kept the slide to the percentages as published.

The line that makes it land:

Notice what she did not do. She did not discount. She did not buy ads. She did not post more. She found the thing standing between someone wanting her cake and someone having her cake, and she removed it.

Before you plan a single post this quarter, ask yourself the same question. If somebody decided right now that they wanted to buy from you, how hard would it be? Because if the answer is "they would have to DM me and wait," then Cyber Monday is not really available to you yet, and that is worth knowing before you put it on your calendar.

That last line is the bridge into the next slide, Which Dates Are Actually Yours.

Video: [Shop owner happy everyone's shopping local on Small Business Saturday](#) · 2:10

Features Sharon Coleman, co-owner of Tinkers and Company, on Small Business Saturday. Not Miette, but it puts a real small shop owner's face on the screen, which is the point. Play it if you want the human version rather than the numbers version.

A story for slide 22, no slide needed

When you are on Six Days in a Row and you get to Small Business Saturday, this is worth thirty seconds:

Small Business Saturday is not an old tradition. American Express made it up in 2010. It did not exist. There was Black Friday for the big stores and Cyber Monday for the internet, and nothing at all for the people in this room. So they invented a day and gave it a name.

Fifteen years later it moves about twenty-two billion dollars, up from seventeen billion the year before.

Sources: [Constant Contact](#). The same report says 72% of shoppers say the day makes them want to shop local all year.

The point to land: the reason to buy local that day is already in the air. You do not have to create it. You have to be findable.

Slide 31 · Do Not Buy This Jacket

Where it sits: Topic 4, right after You Do Not Have to Discount. It is the hardest version of that argument.

The story, in your words:

Black Friday, 2011. Patagonia buys a full page in the New York Times. And the ad says, in big letters, do not buy this jacket. Then it lists what the jacket costs the planet to make.

They did not put anything on sale. They ran the single most anti-sale ad anybody had ever seen, on the single biggest sale day of the year.

The numbers on the slide:

Figure	What it is	Source
\$0	Discounted. Nothing was on sale.	The ad itself
~\$415M	Revenue before	The Brand Hopper
\$543M	Revenue in 2012, the year after	Same

One caution. You will see "sales rose 30%" quoted everywhere for this campaign. It is repeated constantly but poorly sourced, and the causation is genuinely arguable, plenty was happening at Patagonia those years. I left it off the slide and used the revenue figures instead, which are solid. If someone in the room quotes the 30% at you, that is a fine moment to say you prefer numbers you can stand behind.

The line that makes it land:

They did not cut their price. They gave people a reason to believe them. And that is available to every single person in this room, at no cost, this quarter.

If you are a service business or you sell something premium, this is your permission slip. You do not have to discount in December. You have to be worth believing.

Video: [Patagonia's Famous Ad, Don't Buy This Jacket](#) · 0:29

Twenty-nine seconds. Play it, do not describe it.

How to add a video to a slide

The empty frame on the right of each case study slide is for a video still or a screenshot. Two ways:

Easiest, and what I would do today: leave the slide as it is, and just open the YouTube link in a browser tab when you get there. Play it, close the tab, carry on. Nothing to prepare.

If you want it embedded: in PowerPoint, Insert, then Video, then Online Video, and paste the YouTube link. Drop it into the dashed frame on the right. Test it before the room fills up, because embedded video needs a working connection and sometimes it does not cooperate.

A note on these being big brands

All three are large companies, and this room is not. That is deliberate: these are the examples everybody has heard of, which makes the principle land fast. The work is in the translation, and each slide has that translation line at the bottom.

The small-business versions in the Q4 Moment Menu, the barber running a Halloween poll, the salon naming ten loyal clients, the four shops sharing one flyer, are illustrations of the principle, written to be recognisable. They are not documented case studies of real named businesses, so present them as "here is what this looks like at your size," not as "here is a business that did this." That distinction matters in a room of people who will go and check.

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